

450 Podcast Production Team

Description & Eligibility

The team will research and create a three to five (3:00-5:00) minute podcast based on the assigned topic. Any secondary or postsecondary division contestant may enter this judged team event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. Teams must be registered for the national competition before the submission deadline and compete in both parts of the event to be ranked. Entries that do not follow the provided topic or the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and the Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy will be disqualified.

Topic

Podcast Production Team – Myth vs. Reality: Teenagers and Technology. Create a three (3:00) to five (5:00) minute podcast episode exploring common myths about teenagers’ use of technology and comparing them to real experiences, facts, and perspectives.

Your podcast must include the following:

- Address at least two (2) widely believed myths about teenagers and technology
- Two required myths:
 - Myth #1: “Teenagers are addicted to their phones and cannot function without them.”
 - Myth #2: “Technology only distracts teens and harms their learning.”
- Contrast each myth with real-world evidence, examples, or lived experiences.
- Demonstrate effective audio production techniques (voice clarity, pacing, transitions, and sound elements).
- Include a clear takeaway message about how technology truly affects teenagers today.

Teams may include additional myths but must cover both required myths. The podcast should be informative, balanced, and appropriate for a K – 12 school audience.

Team Must Supply

- Students may use one single-sided laptop, notebook, or tablet for their presentation. Projection equipment and external displays will not be provided or permitted.

Competition Notes

- Method of evaluation: judged
- AI Policy Level 1 *No AI Allowed*
- Carry-in and setup of equipment must be done solely by the team within the time allotted
- No Internet access will be provided on-site at NLC; however, contestants may provide their own access to be used only for their presentation to the judges
- No materials may be left with the judges
- Only the team captain should complete the submission
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges’ questions
- Finals may be part of the competition
- Each state is allowed three (3) entries

Technical Pre-Submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	National Deadline
Submit the following in one combined PDF: 1. Clickable URL to Podcast 2. Works Cited 3. BPA Release Form(s) 4. AI Usage and Documentation Form	PPT-TeamID.pdf	April 1, 2027, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

1. Apply audience analysis and design principles & elements to research and develop discussion points, outlines, and scripts, ensuring clear messaging and engagement for a defined target audience across platforms
2. Develop and edit professional lead-in and lead-out segways and implement audio editing and splicing workflows using industry-standard software, incorporating nonlinear editing, mixing, and effects to enhance storytelling and production value
3. Utilize industry-standard audio production software, hardware, and workflows and apply modern recording techniques to capture clear, high-quality sound in various environments, adapting to project needs and technical requirements
4. Collaborate effectively within multidisciplinary audio production teams, utilizing project management and communication platforms to optimize workflow and production quality

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Use of transitions and continuity must exist in the production
- Album artwork must be loaded and shown when the judges select the podcast

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- This is a pre-submitted event. Regional and state conferences have specific deadlines prior to the national deadlines. Please consult the regional or state conference administrator for those deadlines. For the National Leadership Conference, submit the URL to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time on April 1, 2027.
- Upload completed projects to a video/file sharing link (Vimeo, YouTube, Dropbox, etc.). Projects must be viewable on Windows and Mac platforms. Set the access level of your project to one of BPA's recommended settings. See the Cloud Sharing Guidelines for additional information.
- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a signed BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The contestant is responsible for citing all sources, including oneself, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

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Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing clickable URL to Podcast, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> , BPA Release Form(s), and AI Usage and Documentation Form.				/10
Episode title and cover art				/10
Opening/Introduction/Transitions				/10
Closing				/10
Topic addressed with multiple actors and viewpoints				/10
Podcast made effective use of time and was within the audio time limit of 3-5 minutes				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-12 points	Meets Expectations 13-25 points	Above Expectations 26-35 points	Points Awarded
Introduction	Topic somewhat engages the listener. Lacks an introduction or has an unclear purpose.	Introduces the topic and begins to engage the audience. Purpose is somewhat clear.	Catchy, clever intro with relevant info and a clear purpose that engages the listener right away.	/35
Topic Development	All or some of the information is inaccurate or irrelevant to the topic.	Most information is relevant, though the delivery lacks focus and may wander at times.	Creative, original content supports the podcast's purpose. Information is accurate.	/35
Audio Message	The podcast is not engaging & does not invite the listener into the conversation.	The podcast is presented in a moderately engaging way but could use more energy and/or creativity.	The podcast is presented in highly engaging, conversational way that draws the listener in.	/35
Music, Tone, and Audience Appeal	No music, or music is only somewhat appropriate. Volume is too high or too low.	Music fits the podcast's mood and content. Volume is balanced and doesn't overpower the voice.	Music enhances the podcast, suits the mood and content. Volume is well-balanced and clear.	/35
Professionalism & Voice Quality	Delivery appears unrehearsed. The speaker is completely unclear and is expressionless.	Delivery is somewhat rehearsed but still choppy. The speaker is sometimes unclear and/or muddled.	Delivery is well-rehearsed & smooth. The speaker enunciates clearly & uses an appropriate expression.	/35
Use of Ambient Sound & Noise Control	Podcast has very noticeable & distracting background noise and/or interruptions.	Podcast has some background noise and/or interruptions that slightly disturb the audience.	Podcast has zero to very minimal background noise and/or interruptions.	/35
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/270

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines and Artificial Intelligence Usage and Citation Policy.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence, and it is unclear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, and it is not always clear how each team member's role contributes to the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, and each team member's role is clear and integrated into the presentation. Transitions between speakers and/or points are smooth.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-15 points	Meets Expectations 16-30 points	Above Expectations 31-45 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/45
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Setup lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/100

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES